Javier Franco Pinto

Montevideo, Uruguay
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Born March 28, 2003, Durazno, Uruguay ◇ Uruguayan citizen

Education

Universidad de la República, Facultad de Ciencias Económicas y Administración Feb. 2025 - Present
M.Sc. in Economics (Research track), joint program with Facultad de Ciencias Sociales. Montevideo, Uruguay
GPA: 3.74/4.0

- Master's Thesis: *"Does Austerity Redistribute?"* Expected defense: October 2026.

Universidad de la República, Facultad de Ciencias Económicas y Administración Mar. 2021 - Dec. 2024
B.Sc. in Economics. GPA: 3.51/4.0. Degree conferred 2025 Montevideo, Uruguay

Fields of Interest

Macroeconomics · Public/Fiscal Policy · Inequality and Poverty · Household Finance

Research Statement

My research spans two lines within the Institute of Economics at FCEA, Universidad de la República. The first, in macroeconomics and fiscal policy, examines the distributional consequences of fiscal consolidations; my master's thesis draws on a pooled sample of OECD and Latin American and Caribbean economies, with consolidation episodes identified through the narrative approach and analyzed using local projections, to test whether these consequences are shaped by a country's quality of government, a composite measure of state capacity, rather than by region, and whether tax-based and expenditure-based adjustments differ in their distributional effect once state capacity is accounted for. This question is especially urgent given historically elevated public debt and persistently high inequality across both advanced and developing economies. The second line, in inequality and poverty, studies how adverse labor shocks, particularly household-head job loss, affect household financial conditions and access to credit, using individual-level administrative data to trace financial trajectories and assess whether the financial system amplifies or cushions income shocks. Together, these lines connect macroeconomic analysis with micro-level evidence on how public policy and economic shocks shape household welfare and inequality. More recently, I have also grown interested in a third line, on contagious presenteeism in Uruguayan firms: a phenomenon that connects the design of social protection with its unintended effects, as a scheme meant to discourage absenteeism can end up incentivizing workers to show up sick, with direct implications for the design of Sickness Subsidies (Subsidios por Enfermedad) in Uruguay.

Research Experience

Instituto de Economía, Facultad de Ciencias Económicas y Administración, Universidad de la República Jul. 2025 - Present
Research Assistant. Appointed by competitive call 40 hrs/week

- Macroeconomic Analysis and Trade group: research assistant on *"Redistributive Efficiency of Fiscal Policy and State Capacity: A Macroeconomic Analysis Emphasizing Uruguay"* (competitive grant, CSIC [Comisión Sectorial de Investigación Científica], Universidad de la República).
- Inequality and Poverty group: research assistant on *"Interest over Interests: Analysis of Uruguayan Household Debt"* (competitive grant, CSIC), studying the effect of household-head job loss on household debt and credit access using individual-level administrative data.
- Labor Economics group: research assistant on *"Contagious Presenteeism in Uruguayan Firms"*, analyzing the impacts of the interaction between public sick-leave subsidy policies and firm practices that discourage absenteeism on the spread of contagious illness among employees; combining the processing of labor-histories and Sickness Subsidy.

Teaching Experience

Facultad de Ciencias Económicas y Administración, Universidad de la República Aug. 2025 - Present

Teaching Assistant, Statistics 1 10 hrs/week

- Department of Quantitative Methods. Appointed by competitive call. Responsible for practical sessions, exercise design, and course material.

Universidad Católica del Uruguay Aug. 2024 - Dec. 2024

Teaching Assistant, Econometrics 2 4 hrs/week

- Responsible for practical sessions. Developed exercises and solutions; corrected and extended course notes; created evaluation material.

Professional Experience

CPA Ferrere Jul. 2023 - Jun. 2025

Economic Analyst, Economic Analysis and Forecasting Service Montevideo, Uruguay

- Monitored and analyzed national and international macroeconomic indicators; wrote regular briefings for private-sector clients; produced short-term macroeconomic forecasts.
- Advised client firms on macroeconomic conditions; made intensive use of R, Stata, EViews, and Bloomberg for data processing, model estimation, and visualization.

Workshops and Summer Schools

- Winter School 2025 (*Jornadas Anuales de Economía: Escuela de Invierno*). Central Bank of Uruguay.
- LACEA-LAMES 2024. Universidad de la República, Uruguay.
- RIDGE Summer School 2023. Research Institute for Development, Growth and Economics / Central Bank of Uruguay.

Other Writing

- Co-author, "Finanzas departamentales en Uruguay: implicancias en la desigualdad y el desarrollo territorial" [Departmental Finances in Uruguay: Implications for Inequality and Territorial Development]. *La Diaria*, October 10, 2024. ladiaria.com.uy

Languages and Computing Skills

- **Languages:** Spanish (native), English (C2: Certificate of Proficiency in English, Cambridge Assessment English, 2020), Portuguese (intermediate: Centro de Lenguas Extranjeras, Uruguay, 2019).
- **Computing:** R, Stata, EViews, MATLAB, Octave, LaTeX, OxMetrics, Demetra; proficient with MS Office and Bloomberg.